the latter died in 1925. By this time, Yuan Shikai had already passed away, in 1916.

In the reorganization of the party and the army, Sun Yat-sen, and later Chiang Kai-shek, were assisted by the newly established Soviet Union after the Bolshevik Revolution in 1917. Moscow sent Mikhail Borodin as Comintern representative in 1923 to Guangzhou. He helped in organizing the KMT on the lines of the Soviet Communist Party. He also arranged for several CCP cadres to join the KMT and train at Whampoa. This collaboration between the CCP and the KMT would continue until the Northern Expedition (1926–27) launched by Chiang Kai-shek to unite the whole of China by defeating various warlords controlling different provinces. The Communist Party assisted in this effort, but when it tried to establish its own control over Shanghai in 1927, Chiang attacked and decimated the communist cadres in Shanghai, and this marks the beginning of the civil war between the CPC and the KMT.

What were the different currents of thought that were prevalent in the aftermath of the establishment of the ROC? There was a strong interest in Western liberal ideas of representative democracy and individual rights. In the new educational institutions like Beijing University, set up in 1898, a new class of well-read intellectuals was coming to the fore. There were also a large number of young scholars, writers and activists who had gone abroad to study – to Japan, the US, and some to Europe – who were deeply influenced by Western political thought and institutions.

The outbreak of the First World War among European powers and the news of large-scale killings and brutality dented the image of an advanced and superior Western civilization. The disillusionment with the West came to a head during the Peace Conference at Vienna in 1919, where the victors had gathered to draw the contours of a post-war world order. China was present at the conference as one of the victorious Allies, having declared war on the Central Powers (Germany, Austria-Hungary, the Ottoman empire and Bulgaria) in 1917, soon after the US declared war on Germany. The Chinese expectation was that at the end of the war there would be a restitution to China of the territorial concessions Germany had earlier